AI Connector Channel Performance: Executive Summary

Mailchimp vs QuickBooks & ChatGPT vs Claude | April 11, 2026

Scale & Growth Velocity

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
Total connections	4,792	4,830	2,899	2,693
Days since launch	~130	13	130	10
Daily adds (current)	~60 (steady)	280–440	~15 (declining)	~269

Mailchimp is at roughly **half of QBO's scale** on both channels. Claude is the growth story on both platforms — QBO's Claude overtook ChatGPT in 13 days; Mailchimp's Claude will overtake ChatGPT within days at current rates. The critical difference: QBO's ChatGPT holds steady at ~60/day while **Mailchimp's ChatGPT has decayed 67%** from its Jan peak of 45/day to just 15/day. Claude's daily velocity is comparable across platforms (~269 MC vs 280–440 QBO).

User Composition: Existing Accounts, Not New Customers

Over **90% of both ChatGPT and Claude connections on Mailchimp are existing accounts**. Of the connected user base, Claude skews more toward paid plans (**63.4% paid**) than ChatGPT (**52.6% paid**) — both far above any other Mailchimp integration channel (Shopify: 10%, Canva: 18%). These are power users adding AI tools to active accounts, not new customers discovering Mailchimp.

Engagement: Mailchimp's Advantage Over QBO — Claude Leads ChatGPT

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
AI feature engagement (eligible)	53%	49%	**63%**	**82%**
Premium / Advanced tier	73%	68%	**88%**	**96%**

Mailchimp outperforms QBO on engagement across every tier. Within Mailchimp, **Claude users are dramatically more active than ChatGPT**: 82% weekly active vs 63%, with Premium Claude at a near-perfect 96%. Part of this reflects Claude's recency (10 days vs 130), but ChatGPT's 63% at maturity still exceeds QBO's best number (53%). Even ChatGPT's free-tier users show 23% WAU, while Claude's free tier hits 61%.

Product Attachment: Automations Strong, Secondary Products Lag

MC Product	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude	MC Platform Avg	AI Multiplier	QBO Equivalent
Automations	**40%**	**46%**	23%	1.8–2.0×	Payments: 29% / 27% (5.3×)
SMS	**8%**	**5%**	1.9%	2.6–4.2×	Payroll: 19% / 17% (3.1×)
Transactional Email	1.5%	2.0%	2.1%	~1×	BillPay: 18% / 16% (8.6×)
WhatsApp	0%	0%	~0%	N/A	—

Automations is Mailchimp's standout — **46% for Claude** and **40% for ChatGPT**, nearly double the platform average and exceeding QBO's top metric (Payments at 29%). Claude leads ChatGPT by 5.5 pts. However, QBO's **multi-product multiplier is 3–8×** vs Mailchimp's **1.8–4.2×**. QBO's depth across secondary products (Payroll 19%, BillPay 18%) far exceeds Mailchimp's SMS at 5–8%. ChatGPT edges Claude on SMS (8% vs 5%), likely because its older user base has had more time to expand into paid add-ons.

New Customer Acquisition Critical Failure

Channel	New MC Signups	Paid Conversion	Best Traditional	Worst Traditional
ChatGPT	278 (130 days)	0%	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%
Claude	103 (10 days)	1.9% (2 users)	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%

All 278 ChatGPT-sourced signups remain on free plans after 130 days — **not one has converted to paid**. Claude has 2 free-trial starts out of 103. Even the weakest traditional channel converts at 7–10%. The AI connectors are **the lowest-performing acquisition channels in Mailchimp's entire portfolio**. QBO did not report this metric separately, but their strong attachment numbers suggest their AI-sourced users monetize; Mailchimp's do not.

Scorecard

Dimension	QBO vs MC	ChatGPT vs Claude (within MC)
Scale	QBO leads ~2×	ChatGPT leads (2,899 vs 2,693) but Claude will pass imminently
Growth velocity	QBO leads	Claude dominates (269/day vs 15/day)
Engagement	MC leads (+10–33 pts)	Claude leads (82% vs 63% WAU)
Top product attachment	MC leads (Automations 40–46%)	Claude leads (46% vs 40%)
Multi-product depth	QBO leads (3–8× vs 1.8–4.2×)	ChatGPT slightly (8% vs 5% SMS)
New customer conversion	QBO leads (MC at 0–1.9%)	Neither works (0% vs 1.9%)

Strategic Implication

> The AI connectors deliver **strong engagement and Automations adoption among existing paid users** — a genuine competitive advantage over QBO. But they are **failing completely as acquisition channels**: zero meaningful paid conversion from new signups, which even the weakest traditional channel achieves at 7–10%.

Claude is the stronger channel on every forward-looking metric (velocity, engagement, Automations attachment), while ChatGPT is declining and should be monitored for intervention. The key decision: **invest in fixing the free-to-paid funnel for AI-sourced signups**, or formally reposition these channels as retention/engagement tools and measure them accordingly.

Data source: `mc-business-intelligence` BigQuery | Tables: `bi_reporting.integrations`, `bi_reporting.orders`, `bi_reporting.users`, `bi_reporting.users_weekly_rollup`, `bi_reporting_beta.monthly_genai_user_eligibility`, `bi_reporting.sms_daily_rollup`, `bi_reporting.emails_customer_journey`, `bi_reporting.daily_transactional_sends`, `bi_reporting.messaging_outreach_daily_rollup`

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